3R MODEL · Human Capital Digest
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Over 6.7 million Ukrainian refugees remain abroad while 3.6 million are internally displaced, with underfunded IOM programs and winter energy attacks threatening renewed displacement. Ukraine's IT sector shows resilience with 305,000+ tech workers and a $7.85B market, signaling recruit and retain potential. Fellowship programs and diaspora engagement initiatives offer structured pathways to reactivate human capital.

> IOM's Ukraine Crisis Response is less than 7% funded, directly undermining physical preconditions for return and retention — housing and energy stability remain the #1 bottleneck for human capital recovery.

RETURN

Longitudinal Study on Ukrainian Refugees: Tracking Return Intentions

A new longitudinal study tracks 6.7M+ Ukrainian refugees across Europe to understand barriers and motivations for return. Findings will inform policy on diaspora reactivation and reintegration support over the 2022–2026 period.

3R: Provides evidence base for targeted Return policies; identifies what conditions must be met to convert diaspora into returnees.

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UNHCR ExCom: Preparing Ukraine for Return via Housing Investment

At the 77th UNHCR ExCom session, speakers emphasized housing reconstruction and Ukrainian refugee reintegration programs as essential preconditions for voluntary return, highlighting UNHCR's largest Ukrainian response programs.

3R: Directly links physical infrastructure investment to diaspora Return potential; multilateral commitment signals sustained support.

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VoxUkraine Institutional Support: Funding Human Capital Return

Winners of the first Institutional Support round include VoxUkraine, which focuses on supporting the return of Ukrainians and aligning the labor market with economic recovery needs through research and advocacy.

3R: Signals civil society funding flows toward Return and labor market alignment — a key policy-practice bridge.

EDNANNIA.UA

RECRUIT

Razom × Lobby X: Mobilizing Ukrainian Human Potential During War

Razom for Ukraine and Lobby X co-host a recruitment-focused event on October 26, 2026, connecting Ukrainian talent with employers. Lobby X bridges diaspora professionals and domestic vacancies, targeting wartime skill gap solutions.

3R: Direct Recruit initiative activating diaspora talent pipelines and addressing domestic skill shortages through structured matchmaking.

EVENTBRITE.COM

Harvard Kennedy School $100K Fellowship for Ukrainian Professionals

Harvard Kennedy School launched a $100K fellowship fund for Ukrainian mid-career professionals in public administration, aiming to build governance and policy capacity for post-war reconstruction leadership.

3R: Recruits and upskills strategic governance talent; risks brain drain if fellows don't return — needs repatriation conditionality.

KYIVPOST.COM

Ukraine IT Market 2026: 305,000+ Developers, 132 AI/ML Vacancies

Ukraine's IT sector reached $7.85B with 305,000+ tech professionals and a record 132 AI/ML vacancies, ranking among Europe's top tech talent pools. Resilience amid war underscores recruitment value for global partners.

3R: Quantifies Ukraine's recruit-ready tech talent pool; AI/ML vacancies signal urgent upskilling and international hiring opportunity.

ALCOR.COM

RETAIN

IOM Warning: Damaged Homes and Energy Attacks Risk New Displacement

IOM warns that 3.6M internally displaced Ukrainians and 3.8M returnees face renewed displacement this winter due to damaged housing and energy infrastructure attacks, undermining retention of those who already returned.

3R: Critical Retain risk: physical insecurity directly drives secondary displacement and reverses human capital recovery gains.

IOM.INT

IOM Crisis Response Less Than 7% Funded: Retain Mechanisms at Risk

IOM's 2026 Ukraine Crisis Response Plan is critically underfunded at below 7%, leaving home repair, energy support, and livelihood programs unable to scale — directly threatening population retention and stability.

3R: Funding gap is the #1 systemic threat to Retain: without shelter and energy, no population stabilization is possible.

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GLOBAL CONTEXT

OECD Slovenia: AI Upskilling as Workforce Model for Ukraine

OECD recommends Slovenia expand continuous AI upskilling and reskilling programs. The framework mirrors skills gap challenges Ukraine faces and offers a replicable model for workforce modernization relevant to Ukrainian labor policy.

3R: Provides a peer-country policy model for AI-driven reskilling applicable to Ukraine's Recruit and Retain agenda.

OECD.ORG

Ukrainian Drone Strikes on Russian Data Centers: Tech Workforce Implications

Ukrainian drone strikes targeting Russian data centers mark a new phase of cyber-physical warfare. This demonstrates Ukraine's advanced drone and tech capability, potentially influencing defense-tech talent demand and IT sector priorities.

3R: Signals growing defense-tech talent demand in Ukraine; shapes Recruit priorities toward cybersecurity and drone engineering skills.

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